All the superglobals are themselves contained within a special (super?) superglobal called, rather intuitively, `$GLOBALS`. Below is a truncated view of that variable on my system, which in this example is running PHP 8.0 under the `cli` *SAPI* environment. This is a multi-dimensional array data structure; if it's the first time you've seen one, feel free to have a quick peek at Chapter 5, "Array":

```
var_dump($GLOBALS);
```

```
Output:
array(8) {
  ["_GET"]=> ...
  ["_POST"]=> ...
  ["_COOKIE"]=> ...
  ["_FILES"]=> ...
  ["argv"]=> ...
  ["argc"]=> ...
  ["_SERVER"]=>
  array(67) {
    ["HOSTNAME"]=>
    ...
  }
  ["GLOBALS"]=>
  *RECURSION*
}
```

Notice the `*RECURSION*` at the end of the structure; this means that `$GLOBALS['GLOBALS']` is a reference back to `$GLOBALS`. If `var_dump()` continued to follow that reference, it would then hit another, then another, running in a loop until some part of the system gave up. We look at references in the next section, and recursion is also a topic in Chapter 5, "Array." Note that PHP 8.1 removed the `$GLOBALS["GLOBALS"]` reference.

Each of the top-level array elements (the keys with the leading underscore characters such as `["_SERVER"]`, and also `["argv"]` and `["argc"]`) are also superglobal variables. Simply prepend the key name (e.g., `_GET`, `_POST`, etc.) with a `$` symbol to access it like this: